Scott DeMers'

Dragons Down

Scenarios

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Scenario 1: ENTERING DRAGONS DOWN

An introduction to Dragons Down for 1-2 Heroes

LORE

You've heard the tales of Dragons Down, where mighty dragons descended to earth, laying waste to all in their path. Now, the moment of reckoning is at hand. You've embarked on an arduous journey spanning more than a month, leaving the comforts of your home far behind.

Whispers of hidden chambers and crypts, even the remnants of a forsaken city, that conceal riches beyond your wildest imagination, have spread like wildfire. Little do these rumor-mongers realize the enormity of your aspirations.

With you you've carried the essentials - your meager possessions, snugly fitting into the bounds of your backpack, and, of course, your trusty weapon. For it is certain that the treasures that beckon are guarded by ... something. With a resolute heart, you take that first step into the mystical world of Dragons Down, where destiny and danger await in equal measure....

PLAYER COUNT

Entering Dragons Down is an adventure for one or two players.

SETUP

Entering Dragons Down is an introductory scenario that uses only the Malevolent Mountains terrain pack.

- Entering Dragons Down uses the Open Realm rules as described in the rulebook.
- Set up the game map as shown in the lower right. Setup the rest of the game normally as per the rulebook.

GAME LENGTH

A maximum of 30 turns

VICTORY CONDITIONS

Multi-player

Most Legend Points at the end of 30 turns wins the game... even if the hero is dead.

Solo

Retire with 12 or more legend points without dying. If you can get to 16 legend points, you truly are a legendary hero.

STRATEGY TIPS

- If able, visit the scholar to sell excess treasures and to see if he has any useful wares for sale. You might have to haggle to get a price you can afford.
- Spend time searching for hidden paths to use later. The mountains are difficult for movement.
- The High Pass and Barriers are bad choices for a starting map tile. Both force you to search for hidden paths to make the tile easier for movement... unless you brave the caves underneath the Barriers to get to the Keep.
- The Keep is a safe haven from the monsters. It is centrally located for you. Since movement is difficult in this scenario, it makes sense to head to the Keep and use it to explore the other map tiles.
- Sneak often. It will save your life at least once in this scenario. The mountains are full of monsters that can be difficult to kill.
- Have fun!

Scenario 2: THE TROVE OF THE GREAT WYRM

An Epic Quest for One Hero

LORE

The Golden Icon, Summoning Marcation, and Icon of the Dragon are epic treasures that are sacred to the Knights of the Bannerets. The Knights spent years accumulating these three great treasures and the Lord of the Keep kept them locked in the vault deep in their Keep.

Alas, the vault was broken into and the treasures disappeared in the middle of the night. A network of spies and informants has determined that the treasures are now part of the trove protected by the Great Wyrm in the Black Caves.

The Knights have recruited YOU to retrieve the treasures for them and, if possible, remove the threat posed by the Great Wyrm and its minions. Return the treasures, kill the dragon, earn your fame, and become a legend!

PLAYER COUNT

The Trove of the Great Wyrm is an adventure for one player.

SETUP

Terrain Packs

The Trove of the Great Wyrm uses the entire Malevolent Mountains terrain pack, plus a few pieces from the Cruel Caves terrain pack.

- Remove the Forgotten City wilderness token from the Mountain tokens and place all other Mountain wilderness tokens on the terrain setup card. No other wilderness tokens will be used in this scenario.
- Place the Trove site token face-up on the Cruel Caves setup card. Shuffle the Chamber, Crypt, and Hoard site tokens from the Malevolent Mountains terrain pack and place them near the setup card for the mountains.
- Fill the Trove on the Cruel Caves terrain setup card with 3 random Treasures. From the Deep Treasures card piles, remove the Icon of the Dragon, Summoning Marcation, and Golden Icon treasures, shuffle them, and place them on top of the 3 treasures on the Trove setup location.
- Randomly place 4 treasures, 2 items, and 4 missions on the scholar location on the Mountains terrain setup card. Then shuffle the Deep Treasures, Treasures, Spells, Missions, and Item decks normally.
- Place the Keep map tile in the center of the table. Place the square Keep counter and the round Knight chips on clearing 3 in the Keep tile. Place the Scholar on the map tile next to the Keep. The Scholar is the only merchant in the game.
- Randomly shuffle the mountain tiles together to create a map tile stack and place the Black Caves map tile on top of the stack.
- Player may select any lineage and class card combination they wish. Place the selected hero's counter on the clearing containing the Keep.

GAME LENGTH

A maximum of 30 turns

VICTORY CONDITIONS

To win, the hero must retire in the clearing containing the Keep on or before turn 30 and have earned the number of legend points shown below:

10 Legend Points: Local Hero: You receive free drinks whenever you frequent one of the Keep's pubs.

12 Legend Points: Regional Hero: ...and throughout the land of Dragons Down, you are known for your deeds during this adventure.

14 Legend Points: National Hero: ...and the King and Queen publicly laud your accomplishments throughout the realm and proclaim a day of celebration in your honor.

16 Legend Points: Legendary Hero: ...and bards write and sing songs about you. Your name is on the lips of every child in the realm. You will never be forgotten.

SPECIAL RULES

Exploration:

This scenario uses the optional exploration rules explained under the Explore action in the main rules.

The Trove:

The last tile placed via an exploration action will be the Black Caves. When placed, do not place a wilderness token. Instead, place the Trove in the tile in clearing 2.

Legend Point Scoring

In this scenario, fame is earned normally. But, no legend points are earned in any way except as follows:

- Killing the Great Wyrm: 2 LPs
- Trade action at the Keep to return the Icon of the Dragon: 1 LP
- Trade action at the Keep to return the Summoning Marcation: 1 LP
- Trade action at the Keep to return the Golden Icon: 1 LP
- Retiring at the Keep: Convert every 10 fame into 1 LP.

STRATEGY TIPS

- Choose your hero wisely. Some combinations are better suited than others.
- You have less time than you think to complete your goals.
- A compact map provides faster movement, but more danger for you.

Scenario 3: Absolved of your Sins

A Mission-Focused Scenario for 2-4 Outlaws

Lore

You have lived on the edges of society for much of your life, building up strength and wealth and more at the expense of others. That is why you are drawn to the far reaches of civilization. A place where you can live and take what you want and do as you wish. Frankly, your main desire is simply to be left alone. Alas, that is not to be.

Rumors are that the King's inquisitor is traveling to this very place to rid it of outlaws, ruffians, and thieves. Of course, this means you. The inquisitor is among the most powerful of priests in the entire realm. His magic is irresistible and for him to find you is to guarantee yourself a prison cell... or worse.

You sit in a darkened room, wondering what to do. You don't want to change, but perhaps the time has come to alter your ways....

Player Count

Absolved of your Sins is an adventure for 2 to 4 players.

Setup

Terrain Packs

This scenario uses the Malevolent Mountains and Cruel Caves terrain packs.

- Set Dragons Down up normally using the Open Realm rules.
- Place the High Priest from the Wicked Woods terrain pack on the clearing containing the Keep. No other components from the Wicked Woods terrain pack will be used in this game session. There are special rules explained below for the High Priest in this scenario.
- Shuffle and deal the quests (*White missions*) from the Malevolent Mountains and Cruel Caves terrain packs to each player until all players have an equal number of quests. Shuffle any excess into the mission deck.
- Shuffle and deal the atrocities (*Red missions*) from the Malevolent Mountains and Cruel Caves terrain packs to each player until all players have an equal number of atrocities. Each player selects one to keep in their possession. Shuffle rejected and excess atrocities into the mission deck.
- Give each player one outlaw token.

Game Length

Maximum of 30 turns

Victory Conditions

Normal victory conditions plus one instant victory condition.

Men tremble in your presence. You are remembered as the most foul villain to ever roam the land of Dragons Down... unless you are redeemed (see below).

INSTANT VICTORY: A redeemed hero that retires instantly wins the game. A hero is redeemed if they complete their initial atrocity and then have no outlaw tokens in their possession when they retire. *You are remembered as a hero to many and a scourge to others. But all agree that you were willing to do whatever it took to achieve your goals.*

Special Rules

Atrocity Scoring

Atrocities earn a bonus of +3 legend points and +20 fame.

Redemption

A hero that discards an outlaw token after completing their initial atrocity instead discards all outlaw tokens in their possession (and is redeemed for victory purposes).

The High Priest

The High Priest seeks out and absolves outlaws of their sins. The following rules apply to the High Priest:

- **High Priest Target:** At the end of each combat phase, the High Priest will move towards the hero with the most outlaw tokens using the shortest route. In case of a tie for outlaw tokens, move to the closest outlaw. In case of a tie for distance, determine randomly.
- **High Priest Movement:** Roll one hide die. If the symbol shows a blank, move the High Priest 1 clearing. If the symbol shows a red noise symbol, move the High Priest 2 clearings. If the High Priest is already in a clearing with an outlaw, the High Priest will not move.
- **Hiding from the Priest:** Heroes may hide from the High Priest using normal hide rules.
- **Absolution:** If the High Priest is in the same clearing as an unhidden outlaw after High Priest Movement, that outlaw is absolved of their sins and removed from the game as if they were killed by a monster.

Strategy Tips

- The High Priest introduces an additional element to Dragons Down. Try to stay as far away as possible and let him pursue other players.
- It is very difficult to win this scenario without completing your atrocity. But, do you first try to get rid of your outlaw token by completing your quest to get the High Priest off your trail?
- If playing with the player vs. player rules, this scenario is brutal. Remember, you may discard an outlaw token by killing an outlaw. And everyone starts as an outlaw.

Scenario 4: WANDERERS OF FATE

A Choose-Your-Own-Adventure for Any Number of Heroes

LORE

The adventurers arrived by the hundreds, looking to find fame or fortune, or perhaps an all-powerful treasure to become stronger, or to find the legendary spells books and scrolls that were said to exist in the darkest parts of the wilderness.

Regardless of their past, these adventurers had arrived with their own goals in mind. Each with their own definition of success. Will you be a monster hunter and learner of the arcane arts? Do you seek treasure and money? Do you seek fame and spells? What is most important to you?

PLAYER COUNT

The Wanderers of Fate is an adventure for any number of players.

SETUP

This scenario uses either the Open Realm or Explore the Realm rules as described in the rulebook - whichever the players wish to use. Players may use any terrain packs they wish.

This scenario adds a special step to setup. When players select their heroes, they also record in their adventure journal the categories of achievements that are important to them. The possible categories are Epic Treasures, Spells, Gold, and Fame. Each player records a total of four points spent across all categories. For example, a player could record 2 for Epic Treasures, 1 for Spells, 1 for Gold, and 0 for Fame.

The number of LPs earned in each category will be multiplied by the number of points entered by the player for that category.

GAME LENGTH

A maximum of 30 turns

VICTORY CONDITIONS

Normal victory conditions apply except as follows:

- No LPs are earned during the game. Fame is earned normally.
- When a hero retires or dies, LPs are calculated as follows:
  - The hero receives 1 LP for each Epic Treasure the hero possesses at that moment, multiplied by the number they entered for Epic Treasures.
  - The hero receives 1 LP for each Spell the hero can cast at that moment, ignoring hero starting spells, multiplied by the number they entered for Spells.
  - The hero receives 1 LP for each 20 Gold the hero possesses at that moment, multiplied by the number they entered for Gold. Heroes must subtract their starting gold from their total before calculating their score. Fractions are ignored.
  - The hero receives 1 LP for each 10 Fame the hero possesses at that moment, multiplied by the number they entered for Fame. Fractions are ignored.
  - Roll for gaining or losing LPs due to outlaw tokens as normal.
  - If the hero is dead subtract 3 LPs from the hero's final score. If the hero is alive, but not in a civilization clearing, subtract 2 LPs from the hero's final score.

Multiplayer

Whichever hero has the most LPs wins the game. In case of a tie, the players share the victory.

Solo

A player must score 30 LPs to win the game.

SPECIAL RULES

There are no special rules for this scenario other than the special victory conditions.

STRATEGY TIPS

- Be sure to combine your hero selection with your victory conditions. A Dwarf Barbarian is ill-suited to learning spells... just as a Halfling Enchanter may not be adept at gaining Fame.
- Some of the categories are not complimentary. For example, if you choose both Epic Treasures and Gold as your important categories, you may not be able to score maximum LPs because Epic Treasures are very valuable.
- Each category is tied to a specific action, but many of them have some overlap. For example: Fame comes primarily from killing monsters, but you can earn it in a variety of ways.

Scenario 5: THE EVIL BEHIND IT ALL

A Mystery Adventure for One Hero

LORE

You wake up, your head throbbing from the beating. "Who hit me?", you wonder. All you know is that you were traveling to the great keep when you ... well, you don't remember what happened. All you know is that you awoke in the woods near a trail with ...nothing. You have been waylaid.

Everything is gone. Whatever possessions you had are nowhere to be found. Only meaningless tatters of your life scattered about the area. "Who did this to you? I will find out... and they will pay...".

PLAYER COUNT

The Evil Behind It All is an adventure for one player.

SETUP

This scenario uses the Explore the Realm rules using the Wicked Woods, Cruel Caves, and Malevolent Mountains terrain packs. For a greater challenge, terrain packs from other expansions may be added to this scenario.

This scenario uses the following special setup rules:

- Players may select any hero. The hero receives no items, spells, or gold regardless of lineage card or class selection. You start with nothing but your action cubes and health.
- Place a random Wicked Woods wilderness map tile in the center of the play area. The player places their hero in any clearing on that map tile as their starting location. Then shuffle the remaining map tiles and create a stack of explorable map tiles (*as normal for Explore the Realm*).
- Remove the High Priest, Dwarf Leader, and Knight Leader counters and place them off to the side near the gaming area.

GAME LENGTH

A maximum of 30 turns

VICTORY CONDITIONS

You must get your revenge. All natives from the native group that attacked you must be killed. If you do this, you immediately win the game if you possess no outlaw tokens.

Otherwise, you lose the game.

SPECIAL RULES

- When taking the explore action the player draws two map tiles and places one of them of their choice. The player may choose to place the other tile on the top or the bottom of the map tile stack.
- No LPs or Fame are tracked in this scenario. Gold is tracked normally.
- When a civilization map tile is revealed, place the location and merchant tiles as normal, but do not place any natives.
- When the hero first enters a clearing containing a civilization location, mix and draw a random native leader from the counters set aside earlier.
  - If the native leader drawn matches the location entered (*e.g. the knight leader at the keep*), that is the native group that is responsible for attacking you. Place all of the matching natives in that location. They immediately are considered monsters - blocking and attacking you.
  - If the native leader drawn does not match the location entered, return it to the pool of randomized leaders and place all of the natives of the matching group (including leader) in the civilization location as per normal rules. *Example: The hero enters the keep. The random leader drawn is the dwarf leader. The knights are not responsible for attacking the hero and are placed in the keep clearing. The dwarf leader is returned to the pool with the other leaders.*
  - No outlaw tokens are earned for fighting with the guilty natives, but are otherwise earned normally.
- When filling the goods for sale for a merchant, also deal 5 random spells from the hero starting spell deck with that merchant. These spells may be purchased individually by the player at 3x the printed cost on the spell card. Any spells purchased in this manner are immediately known (*the hero still needs matching cubes in order to cast the spell*). Spells purchased with spell books or scrolls must still be learned as per normal rules.

STRATEGY TIPS

- You start out very weak with literally no spells or possessions. Perhaps choosing a hero that can run away or hide easily is a good idea.
- You also need strength to kill the responsible natives. Tough choices to balance strength, magic, and speed.
- You will need to earn some gold to buy the spells and equipment needed to kill the guilty natives.

Scenario 6: DUNGEON PARTY

A Cooperative Adventure for 3-4 Heroes

LORE

Looking deep into the empty glass that used to hold your ale, you pondered your life choices. You raise your head to look at your fellow "adventurers", friends really, none of them successful... like you, just another down on their luck plunderer.

The doors to the alehouse kick open; "There has been another attack!" yells the town crier. That makes the 3rd this month and the month is not even half over. You look around and it raises barely a murmur in the crowd. You hate apathy. That was one thing about you that you knew you could believe in.

That's it. Something must be done. You turn to your friends, "I am going to stop this madness once and for all. I may die in the process, but one way or the other, this ends now. Are you with me?" Your friends grumble, but one by one heed your call.

PLAYER COUNT

Dungeon Party is an adventure for three or four players.

SETUP

This scenario uses the Open Realm rules as described in the rulebook using the Malevolent Mountains, Cruel Caves, and Wicked Woods terrain packs. *Special: for added challenge, the players may also include either the Sinister Swamps or Perilous Plains terrain packs, or both, from the Dragons Down: Desolation expansion.*

Players must unravel who is the guilty group behind these attacks and stop them. Prior to starting play, perform the following steps:

- Remove one Bow Orc, one Kobold, and one Goblin Peltast from the game (*if playing with the terrain packs from the Dragons Down: Desolation expansion, also remove one Lizardfolk and one Villager*). Randomly select one of these counters and place it back in the game box without revealing it. This counter is the guilty group who is responsible for these attacks.
- Place the remaining counters in a bowl, bag, or other receptacle without revealing them. These are the innocent groups and are used to help you determine who is guilty. See below under special rules about these counters.

GAME LENGTH

A maximum of 30 turns.

VICTORY CONDITIONS

The players win as a group by killing the leader of the responsible group and not being outlaws (*Leaders are the Orc Lord, Kobold Rex, Goblin King, and Lizardfolk Shaman*). If using the Perilous Plains terrain pack from Dragons Down: Desolation and the villagers are guilty (*cultists*), then all villagers must be dead.

At the end of the game, reveal the guilty counter and discard all outlaw tokens earned for killing any monsters or natives from the guilty group. Other outlaw tokens remain with the heroes. The players may unanimously choose to end the game and reveal the guilty counter at any time to see if they have won the game.

If any hero has an outlaw token when the game ends, everyone loses.

SPECIAL RULES

- If a hero kills any orc, kobold, goblin, or lizardfolk using only melee attacks, the players randomly select one counter from the set aside counters and reveal it. The group represented by the selected counter is not responsible for the attacks.
    - Each group may only provide one counter draw. E.g. if a hero kills a second goblin in this manner, the players do not draw another counter from the pool.
- In addition to Outlaw tokens being earned normally, outlaw tokens are also earned for killing the Orc Lord, Orc Champion, Kobold Rex, Goblin King, and/or Lizardfolk Shaman.
- The players have a teleport action that they may use to teleport as many heroes from any one clearing to any other clearing on the map during the action phase. This may be used once per game and must be unanimously decided by all players. It does not count as an action and is instantaneous.

STRATEGY TIPS

- Gathering information quickly is critical. Will you split up to learn about innocent groups faster or stick together because there is safety in numbers? Humanoids tend to appear in large numbers.
- Treasures may help you, but may not be more important than information.

Scenario 7: I, DEMON

A Fan-Made Adventure for One Hero created by Hector Flores

LORE

After your recent coming-of-age, your dreams are visited by a horrible demon. He claims that you share his blood. "You are mine!", he says, and his laughter is like shattering glass. You awaken to find yourself floating above a fiery pit that once was your home, your family nowhere to be found, you are alone, but the laughter still echoes in your ears. Strangely, your sorrow is replaced with burning rage. Is this a gift or a curse?

PLAYER COUNT

I, Demon is an adventure for one player.

SETUP

This scenario uses either the Open Realm or Explore the Realm rules as described in the rulebook - whichever the players wish to use. Players must use the Cruel Caves terrain pack and may use any additional terrain packs they wish.

The player may select any lineage and class.

In addition to any normal set up, take the Fiery Chasm spell from the starting spells deck and place it near the hero board face-down. This spell may be usable later.

GAME LENGTH

A maximum of 30 turns

VICTORY CONDITIONS

There are two paths to win the game:

Evil path:

After gaining at least one title with each Native group in the game, destroy all Native groups. When any Native in a Native group is killed, any Merchants at the civilization tile flee (remove their tiles from the board). The leader of each Native group must be killed when you are not transformed into the demon (*see special rules below*).

Good path:

After gaining at least 15 LP and while holding no Outlaw tokens, the hero pay 15 LP to remove the demon curse at any civilization tile (*afterwards all special rules no longer apply*). After the curse is lifted you win instantly if you kill the Demon.

When rolling the summoning dice in the map tile with the Altar, you roll twice and take both results (same rules as 'making noise'). On any turn in which you make noise in the Altar map tile, roll three times instead of twice.

Otherwise, you lose the game.

SPECIAL RULES

Darkness:

Merchants sense your darkness. When Haggling, if you did not roll the doors symbol on either die, reroll the Haggle die with the lowest number.

Transform

You may transform into a demon during the Activation step of combat by spending 1 legend point.

While in Demon form:

- The hero can fly as per the regular rules.
- Flip the Fiery Chasm spell that was set aside earlier face-up. The hero can cast this Fiery Chasm spell using any cubes in your possession as if they were the spells cubes for the Fiery Chasm spell (*one of which must be wounded after*). An enchanted tile may satisfy one of the boxes on the spell card per normal rules.
- All your other character statistics remain unaffected when transformed. All normal hero actions remain available.
- The transformation expires at the end of the hero's next action phase. When this occurs, place the Fiery Chasm spell face-down.

The Demon

When the Altar is revealed, immediately place the Demon on the Altar. The Demon remains on the board for the rest of the game unless killed. The tile containing the Altar does not summon any monsters, and the Demon cannot attack the hero or be attacked by the hero (*Special: See Good Path under victory conditions*). The Altar is already discovered and is not lootable. No reward is earned for finding it.

You may perform a Trade action with the Demon to exchange Fame at a rate of 15 fame for 1 LP. You may haggle with the Demon using your highest attribute, to bring this ratio down to 10 Fame for 1LP, or haggle again for 5F for 1 LP. You can gain at most 1 LP per trade action. The demon will also trade treasures at the Altar as part of a separate Trade action as if he were a merchant (commerce).

STRATEGY TIPS

- The more terrain packs in play, the harder this scenario becomes to win via the evil path. But, too few terrain packs and getting to 15 LPs is difficult via the good path.